

Biometrics

There's something about the name Henry that seems to inspire a revolution. Be it Henry Ford with his automobile, or in this case, Henry Faulds, the guy who discovered fingerprints and their uniqueness



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Way back in the 1880s, while in Japan, Henry Faulds studied the prints left behind by craftsmen on ancient clay fragments. He then went on to study his own and his colleagues' fingerprints. This convinced him that each individual had unique fingerprints. A little later, a fellow worker was arrested by the police for a petty crime. Faulds exonerated the man by showing that the finger prints on the crime scene did not match with those of his friend.

Thus began the journey of the most promising science of identification and recognition: Biometrics. Today, apart from fingerprints (and palm prints for that matter), we have discovered facial recognition, DNA, retinal scanning and voice recognition.

What Is Biometrics?

Biometrics can be defined as the technique of studying the physical characteristics of a person such as fingerprints, hand geometry, eye structure etc. to establish his or her identity. This science is primarily implemented to identify individuals.

Why Biometrics?

The use of biometrics is no longer restricted to defense establishments or sensitive areas. An increased need for security has prompted even everyday office goers to install fingerprint recognition devices to boot up their laptops, thumb drives and other daily use gadgets.

The question is, why? Why isn't the 16-digit password good enough? Simply because fingerprints are more secure. A password is breakable